v158th FW

FLIGHT OPERATIONS

March 2026

This document supersedes any previous versions of v158FWMAN 11-1. Direct any questions to v158th FW WG/CC at sabrevaetc@gmail.com.

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PURPOSE.

The Virtual 158th Fighter Wing Instructional Standard Operating Procedures establish SOPs and saturate resources from the public domain to create a standard for virtual flight operations. This document describes procedures that are unique to v158th FW.

RESPONSIBILITY.

All pilots and onboarded personnel shall be thoroughly familiar with and operate per procedures and policies set forth in this instruction and all applicable references. The policies and procedures in this Instruction are established to maximize mission accomplishment and safety through standardization. Deviations from these procedures are authorized only when sound judgement dictates that flight safety will be compromised unless a justifiable deviation is executed.

REVISIONS.

All pilots are encouraged to submit recommended changes, additions, and improvements to their respective Commanders. (WG/CC > WG/CV > OG/CC > FS/CC)

RELEASING AND DISTRIBUTION.

This Instruction is cleared for public release and is available electronically via v158th FW share drive in v158th FW\Documents\Operating Procedures.

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Chapter 1

Pilot Guidelines

1.1. General Instruction. Wing staff shall stand in accordance with the guidelines set herein.

1.2. Guest Pilots. Adhere to vAFMAN 11-202V3.

1.3 Pilot Currency/Proficiency Guidelines.

1.3.1. Instructor Pilots (IPs) and VSOA qualified guest pilots will adhere to type/model/series currency.

1.3.2. For mission-ready pilots (MRPs) who fail to meet the 31-day requirement of logged flight time per squadron requirements, a flight may be scheduled and flown as a syllabus event at the discretion of the IP of Record with the concurrence from the FS/CC. If performance is safe, the flight may be logged and the pilot filed as current.

1.3.3. A pilot in the MQT phase shall fly their first flight (FFAM/LAO) within 14 days of completing VST and MST.

1.3.4. Additional currency/proficiency requirements for night flying and air combat maneuvering (ACM) are in accordance with AFMAN 11-202V3.

1.3.5. Non-MR pilots are limited to two graded events per day unless waived by FS/CC. Reference v158FWPD 1-1 *Standards and Code of Conduct*.

Figure 1.1. Currency Requirements Table

Days since last flight in an F-35A	**MRP**
0-30	Current.
31-61	1. Removal of MR status 2. Removal from Flight role. 3. Rectified through FFAM of at least 1 hour in duration.
62-92	1. Removal from Squadron reserve status. 2. Rectified through 2 FFAMs with current IP as chase.
93	Termination.

Chapter 2

Mission Planning

2.1. Flight Material Preparation.

2.1.1. Mission Data Card. TOLD data listed on the MDC is maximum abort speed, rotation speed, takeoff speed and distance, landing speed and distance. Each should be adjusted according to inclement conditions, including, but not limited to rain or icing.

2.1.2. Local Area Maps. Local area maps should be studied by the pilot, whether digital or physical. The aircraft TSD can supplement or act as a primary navigation such as the TSD supplement includes sufficient detail to follow operational requirements.

2.1.3. Charts. Flight Information Publication (FLIP) charts shall be supplemented with Local Area Maps, especially regarding precision approach or airfield information.

2.1.4. Electronic Flight Bag (EFB). Information loaded on flying EFBs shall include v158th FW IFG, v158FWTO 11-3 *Normal Operations Checklist*, v158th FW 11-4 *Abnormal Operations Checklist*, and Navigraph or adjacent applications (LNM, ForeFlight, etc.).

2.1.5. Portable Memory Devices (PMDs). Simulated to include Microsoft Flight Simulator .PLN file, Communications Planning, and SAFEREP Video Evidence.

2.2. Aircrew Flight Equipment. Reference v158FWPD 1-1 *Standards & Code of Conduct*

2.3. Checklist Discipline. Refer to v158FWTO 11-3 *Normal Operating Checklist*. Refer to v158FWTO 11-4 *Abnormal Operating Checklist.* Refer to v158FWTTP 3.3-F-35A.

2.4. Briefing/Debriefing.

2.4.1. Briefings. All pilots shall attend the flight briefing unless previously coordinated with the flight lead (FL) or mission commander (MC).

2.4.1.1. General Administration.

2.4.1.1.1. Security.

2.4.1.1.2. Mission Tasking.

2.4.1.1.3. Coordination/Communication.

2.4.1.1.4. Emergency Procedures/Divert Information.

2.4.1.1.5. Weather/NOTAMs.

2.4.1.1.6. TOLD.
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2.4.1.1.8. Field Diagrams/Additional Media.

2.4.1.2. Tactical Administration.
2.4.1.2.1. Mission Objectives.
2.4.1.2.2. Mission Tasks.
2.4.1.2.3. Scenario/Training Tasks.
2.4.1.2.4. Gameplan.
2.4.1.2.5. Communication Flow.
2.4.1.2.6. Air-to-Air Refueling.
2.4.1.2.7. Applicable mission-specific SPINS.
2.4.1.2.8. Airspace Restrictions/Diagram.

2.4.2. Briefing Guides. Reference v158FWSUP *Flight Briefing Guide.*

2.4.3. Debriefings. All pilots shall attend the flight debriefing unless previously coordinated with the flight lead (FL) or mission commander (MC).

Chapter 3

Normal Operations

3.1 Preflight

3.1.1. Pilots shall plan a walk time of NLT 20 minutes prior to scheduled/rolexed takeoff time.

3.1.2. Pilots shall plan an IPP cold start time of NLT 15 minutes prior to scheduled/rolexed takeoff time.

3.1.3. All pilots shall review pre-mission planning, briefing, and VATSIM pre-filing requirements and actions before walking, though ideally after the flight briefing has been concluded. Resources can be found through Operations > Pre-mission Planning on the website.

3.1.4. Pilots shall monitor Maple Ops using the Back-Up Radio (BUR) from IPP start until taxi clearance is assigned. A successful BUR check is required for flight operations.

2.3.5. Prior to leaving the line area, appropriate checklist discipline shall be completed. If hot pits or EORs are required, final before-takeoff checks shall be completed NLT the EOR line area.

2.3.6. Vehicle System Built-In-Test (VS BIT) checks shall be completed prior to intraflight communication.

2.3.7. Automatic Ground Collision Avoidance System (AGCAS) shall be set per pilot preference.

2.3.8. Ejection seat arming should not occur with any vertical obstruction above the aircraft.

3.2. Taxi Procedures:

3.2.1. Unless briefed otherwise, flight aircraft shall marshal facing east on the ramp. Aircraft will fill from east to west based on flight position.

3.2.2. Inline/trail taxi formation with 300’ spacing is standard.

3.2.3. Maximum taxi speed while not on an active runway is 30 knots ground speed.

3.3. Aircraft Lighting.

3.3.1. POSIT and STROB lights shall be on from start up to shutdown during administrative portions of the sortie.

3.3.2. While landing gear is deployed, pilots shall enable landing lighting.

3.3.3. When operating between the hours of civil twilight and civil sunrise, pilots shall limit landing light usage on the ground so as to not impede aircrew vision.

3.3.4. When operating between the hours of civil twilight and civil sunrise, pilots are required to use FORM lights at their brightest setting.

3.4. Takeoff.

3.4.1. During normal operations, departing aircraft will use the full length of available runway to the maximum practical extent.

3.4.2. During formation lineup, 500’ spacing is standard.

3.4.3. Use a minimum of 10 second takeoff interval between aircraft. When carrying live AS ordnance or executing sensor trail departures, use a 20 second takeoff interval.

3.4.4. Formation Takeoff. Not authorized.

3.4.5. Use of afterburner is prohibited during takeoff unless otherwise specified. MIL should be used to the maximum practical extent.

3.4.6. Sensor Trail Departures. Required for flights of two or greater aircraft whenever the weather is less than 3 statute miles of visibility and a cloud ceiling (BKN or OVC) of less than 1000 feet. Shall be coordinated as a non-standard formation with ATC.

3.5. Joinup/Rejoin:

3.5.1. Takeoff rendezvous/rejoins in all conditions will occur at 300 KIAS. FLs may brief alternate rendezvous/rejoin procedures.

3.5.2. Flight members join in sequence. The number two aircraft joins on the left wing, and the second element, if applicable, joins on the right wing.

3.5.3. FLs should direct a battle damage check (BDX) after each mission, except at night or IMC conditions. WBDs should remain closed during BDX.

3.6. Visual/Administrative Formation.

3.6.1. In IMC, the maximum flight size in a visual formation is four aircraft, except when flying in close formation with a tanker.

3.6.2. Changing Leads. A radio call is mandatory when directing position changes. The old lead aircraft should decelerate and rejoin on the new lead aircraft.

3.6.3. Loss of Visual. Flight members will call "blind" with callsign and altitude in thousands of feet. The visual flight member responds with "visual" and attempts to talk-on the blind member to the formation. If no timely acknowledgement of the blind call occurs, the flight member acknowledging the call with maneuvers in accordance with v158FWTO *Abnormal Operating Checklist.*

3.7. Ops Checks.

3.7.1. At a minimum, ops checks shall be completed and directed via radio call by the FL after initial climb, prior to and following each engagement/intercept/attack, and following AAR.

3.7.2. Standard items include ICAWS, Fuel, Oxygen, and max-G (IFOG).

3.8. G-Awareness Exercise. Execute IAW v158FWTTP 3-3.F-35A. Should occur in SUA.

3.9. Radio Procedures.

3.9.1. Preface all communications with complete flight callsign.

3.9.2. Acknowledge radio checks that do not require the transmission of specific data by individual flight members in turn (e.g. "2, 3, 4").

3.9.3. Each pilot reports landing gear down to the controlling ATC agency or runway supervisory unit after extending the landing gear prior to crossing the runway threshold.

3.10. Air Refueling. Execute IAW v158FWTTP 3-3.F-35A.

3.11. Night Procedures.

3.11.1. DAS/NVCS operations shall not be enabled during departure until at least 2,000 feet AGL.

3.11.2. DAS/NVCS During AAR. DAS/NVCS is authorized, but disabled no later than astern.

3.11.3. DAS/NVCS Landings. Not authorized.

3.12. Fuel Requirements.

3.12.1. Normal Recovery Fuel. The planned fuel quantity at the initial approach fix (IAF) of intended landing or alternate is 2,300 pounds.

3.12.2. Minimum Fuel State. 1,900 pounds.

3.12.3. FUEL CRITICAL. 1,000 pounds.

3.13. Approaches and Landings.

3.13.1. Minimum touchdown spacing between landing aircraft is 3,000 feet for F-35s and 6,000 feet for dissimilar aircraft.

3.13.2. Land in the center of the runway and clear to the cold side when speed and conditions permit. After achieving a safe taxi speed, do not delay clearing to the cold side.

3.13.3. Formation Approaches. Normally accomplish formation approaches from a published instrument approach or a VFR straight-in approach using available glideslope guidance.

3.13.4. Formation Landings. Not authorized.

3.14. Overhead Traffic Patterns. Reference v158FWTTP 3-3.F-35A and requirements as outlined in v158FWI 11-2 *Local Area Procedures.*

3.15. Touch-and-Go Landings. Touch-and-go landings may be flown for training requirements and as outlined in v158FWI 11-2 *Local Area Procedures.*

3.16. Low Approaches. Execute so that touchdown does not occur.

3.17. Closed Traffic Patterns. Initiate the pattern at the departure end of the runway.